



Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Pronunciation Spot: Promises, promises, promises.



Learning Outcome

Describe situations in written and spoken interactions according to social contexts.

Ask your partner:

- How often do you make promises?
- Do you always keep your promises?
Why or why not?

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about friendship, relationships, feelings and reactions.
- I can stress *I* and *you*.
- I can use proper intonation in finished and unfinished ideas.





Let's Explore!

It's just **the honest truth***!

* When you say that a story is "*the honest truth*" you let the listener know you are being extra sincere.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Well ... I have to tell you ... over the years, I've learned about people and promises! Most people just make promises without paying too much attention to what they are saying. I mean ... remember when you were small? People made lots of promises. I don't know about you, but I believed them all! Did you? Well ... maybe I was much more gullible than you were. I believed everything!

"If you eat your spinach, you'll be strong," my grandmother used to say. I ate my spinach zealously ... I was never what you'd call robust. "If you wear a sweater, you won't catch a cold," my mom lovingly intoned all winter. I always wear a sweater. Do you? I always come down with a cold as well!

My dad said, "If you practice enough, you'll become a great basketball player." It took me several years to ascertain that practice wasn't a magic formula. I was never going to be a professional basketball player.

As an adult, I no longer believe in easy answers. What about you? If you want to convince me of something ... to persuade me with a catchy phrase ... think again.

Interestingly enough, despite life's lessons showing me that promises had nothing to do with reality, I always feel especially good when I have spinach for dinner, put on a warm sweater, or go out into the yard to play a little basketball! That's the honest truth ... I promise!





Let's Practice!

What does Sara say about promises?

Instructions: Match the two parts of the sentences from Column A to Column B.

COLUMN A

1. Well ... I have to tell you ... over the years,
2. I mean ... remember when you were small?
3. I don't know about you,
4. Well ... maybe I was much more
5. I ate my spinach zealously ...

COLUMN B

- a. I was never what you'd call robust.
- b. People made lots of promises.
- c. I've learned about people and promises!
- d. but I believed them all!
- e. gullible than you were. I believed everything!



Let's Practice!

Talking about feelings and reactions.

Instructions: Read the sentences Write the missing words. Use Zealous, despite, Disappointingly, or ascertain.

1. Interestingly enough, _____ life's lessons showing me that promises had nothing to do with reality, I always feel especially good when I have spinach for dinner.
2. _____, most people just make promises without paying too much attention to what they are saying.
3. Unfortunately, It took me several years to _____ that practice wasn't a magic formula. I was never going to be a professional basketball player.





Extension Activity

Listen to a song about promises.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Go online or to the library and look up the lyrics to the song "Promises, Promises" written by Burt Bacharach.
- Read through them and say the lyrics aloud.
- Now go find someone singing the song online or on CD at the library.
- Listen without reading the lyrics the first time.
- Go back to the lyrics and highlight words that you didn't hear or that were hard to hear.
- Listen again with the lyrics sheet.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I find the lyrics and song to "Promises, Promises" written by Burt Bacharach.

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I read through the lyrics then listen to the song.

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I note any words that were difficult to hear.

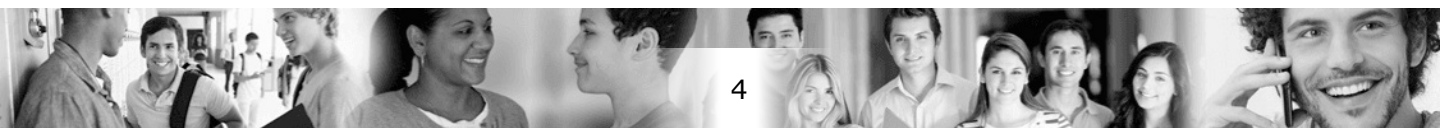
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I listen to the song again with the lyrics sheet.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- to pay attention** (verb): to focus on something or someone without distraction
e.g. People just make promises without paying too much attention to what they are saying.
- gullible** (adjective): easy to deceive; easily believes everything other people say
e.g. Maybe I was much more gullible than you were.
- zealously** (adverb): done eagerly and with enthusiasm
e.g. I ate my spinach zealously.
- robust** (adjective): strong and healthy
e.g. I was never what you'd call robust.
- to intone** (verb): to say something slowly and seriously in a voice which does not rise or fall much
e.g. "If you wear a sweater, you won't catch a cold," my mom lovingly intoned all winter.
- to come down with** (expression): to catch or show signs of an illness
e.g. I always come down with a cold in the winter.
- to ascertain** (verb): to discover something, or to make sure of something
e.g. It took me several years to ascertain that practice wasn't a magic formula.
- despite** (preposition): without being influenced or prevented by
e.g. I always feel especially good despite promises which had nothing to do with reality.
- life's lessons** (expression): experiences from which useful knowledge or principles can be learned
e.g. Despite life's lessons showing me that it's hard to work with others, I always feel especially good after playing basketball with my friends.
- That's the honest truth!** (expression): used to express deep sincerity
e.g. That's the honest truth ... I promise!





Learning Points

Stressing **You** and **I**

You stress **you** and **I** to add meaning and emphasis to a statement.

When you stress a word, you make it longer, louder and a little higher tone. You can put stress on a word to emphasize it and make your meaning clearer.

You stress **you** or **I** when you want to emphasize something about a person that is not expected.

For example:

*I'm good. But how about **you**?*

- When you put stress on **you**, you shift the emphasis to the other person.

Read these sentences with stress on the bolded words.

- *Well ... maybe **I** was much more gullible than **you** were.*
- *I don't know about **you**, but **I** believed them all!*
- ***I** always wear a sweater. Do **you**?*
- *As an adult, **I** no longer believe in easy answers. What about **you**?*





Learning Points

Intonation of Finished and Unfinished Ideas

Intonation tells us a lot about how someone feels and whether they have completed their thoughts or not. It is important to listen carefully to the rise and fall of people's voices.

In English, there are three intonation patterns:

1. Falling
2. Rising
3. Partial Falling

You should use falling intonation at the end of a thought group or sentence to tell the listener that you are finished with that statement.

For example:

Most people just make promises without paying too much attention to what they are saying.

Likewise, your pitch will only partially fall at the end of a thought group to:

- give the listener's brain time to "digest" the speech; and
- tell the listener that you are not finished speaking.

For example:

Well ... I have to tell you ...

Examples:

- *If you want to convince me of something ... to persuade me with a catchy phrase ... think again.*
- *That's the honest truth ... I promise!*
- *Well ... maybe I was much more gullible than you were. I believed everything!*
- *I mean ... remember when you were small? People made lots of promises.*

